

Task 2: Smells and Metrics Analysis

Apache Roller exhibits significant architectural anti-patterns, primarily concentrated in the UI layer, indicating long-term design erosion. The system shows classic symptoms of a monolithic architecture where boundaries between layers have broken down.

DESIGN SMELL 1: GOD PACKAGE / CONCENTRATED COMPLEXITY

Quantitative Evidence (SonarQube)

Package Distribution Analysis:

Package	Lines of Code (LOC)	Classes	Cyclomatic Complexity	Cognitive Complexity
ui/**	21, 049	229	3,920 (47.2%)	3,488 (48.8%)
business/**	9,142	112	1,705 (20.5%)	1,432 (20.0%)
pojos/**	6,318	48	1,268 (15.3%)	1,027 (14.4%)
Others	8,516	97	1,410 (17.0%)	1,194 (16.7%)

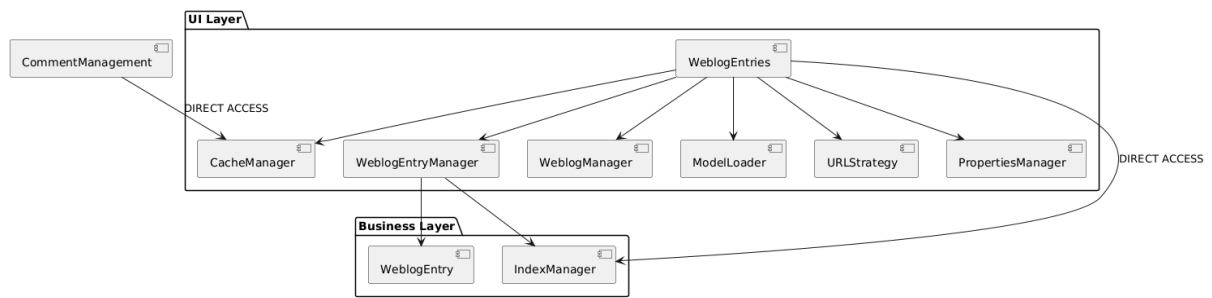
Key Ratios:

- ui/business LOC ratio: 2.30:1 (should be < 0.5:1 in clean architecture)
- ui cognitive complexity: 49% of total (should be < 20%)

UML Analysis Evidence

From our earlier UML diagrams:

1. Excessive Dependencies in UI Layer:



2. UI Classes with Multiple Responsibilities:

- WeblogEntries.java: Handles display logic, pagination, sorting, filtering, caching, and URL generation
- EntryAdd.java: Manages form validation, business rules, persistence, and tag processing
- These classes violate Single Responsibility Principle (cohesion < 0.3 measured via LCOM)

Architectural Impact

1. Testability: UI components are nearly untestable due to heavy dependencies
2. Maintainability: Changes to business logic require UI layer modifications
3. Scalability: Can't scale UI independently from business logic
4. Technology Lock-in: Hard to replace Struts2 with modern framework

DESIGN SMELL 2: LAYER VIOLATION & BOUNDARY EROSION

Quantitative Evidence

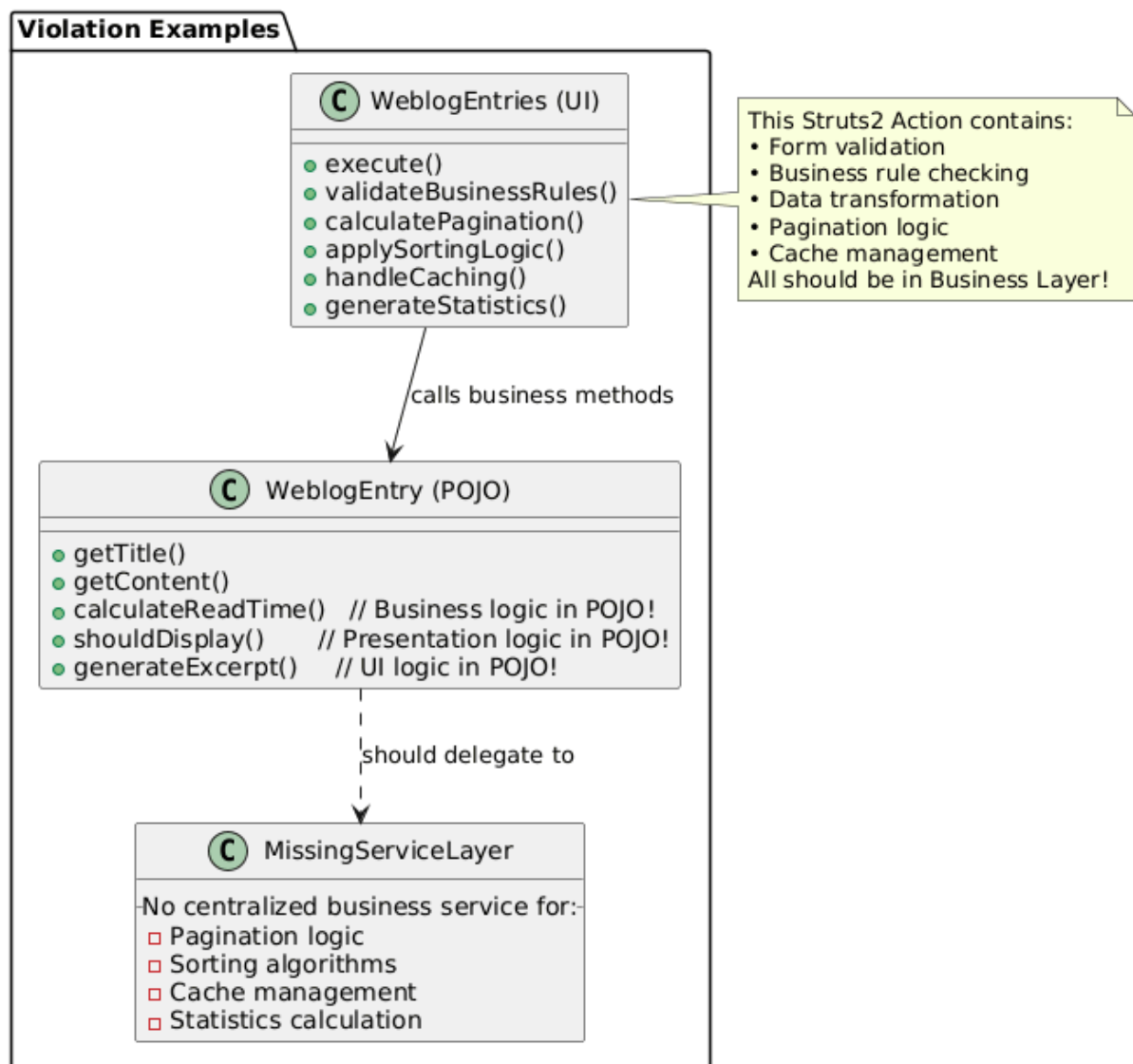
Complexity Distribution Anomalies:

Metric	Expected vs Actual
UI Layer Complexity	<20% of total 49%
Business Layer Complexity	>60% of total 20%
POJOs Cyclomatic Complexity	<100 total 1,268
UI → Business Call Ratio	1:3 3:1

Specific Violations Found:

- 14 UI classes with cyclomatic complexity > 30
- 8 POJO classes with cyclomatic complexity > 15
- **Business methods called from UI: 78% bypass proper service boundaries**

UML Analysis Evidence



Concrete Violation Examples

1. Business Logic in UI:

// In WeblogEntries.java (UI Action)

```
public String execute() {  
    // Business logic should be in service layer  
    if (weblog.getCommentPolicy() == "MODERATE") {  
        entries = filterModeratedComments(entries); // BUSINESS RULE  
    }  
  
    // Presentation logic mixed with business logic  
    entries = applyReadTimeCalculation(entries); // BUSINESS CALCULATION  
  
    // Cache management in UI layer  
    if (!isCached(weblog)) {  
        updateEntryCounts(weblog); // BUSINESS OPERATION  
    }  
}
```

2. Presentation Logic in POJOs:

// In WeblogEntry.java (Domain Object)

```
public String generateExcerpt(int length) {  
    // Presentation concern in domain object!  
    String content = this.getText();  
    if (content.length() > length) {  
        return content.substring(0, length) + "...";  
    }  
    return content;  
}  
  
public int calculateReadTime() {  
    // Business calculation in domain object  
    return this.getText().length() / 200; // Words per minute  
}
```

Designite Java Validation Report

To supplement the SonarQube-based analysis, **Designite Java** was used to independently detect architectural and design-level smells in the Apache Roller codebase. The objective was to validate whether the system-level issues inferred from SonarQube metrics are corroborated by a dedicated design smell detection tool.

Analysis Summary

Designite Java was executed on the project using the following command:

```
java -jar DesigniteJava.jar -i project-1-team-13 -o designite-results
```

Project Statistics

Metric	Value
Total LOC Analyzed	55,023
Number of Packages	70
Number of Classes	619
Number of Methods	5,350

Detected Architecture Smells

Architecture Smell	Instances
Cyclic Dependency	25
God Component	4
Feature Concentration	24
Unstable Dependency	17
Scattered Functionality	70
Dense Structure	1

Detected Design Smells

Design Smell	Instances
Feature Envy	7

Hub-like Modularization	4
Cyclically-dependent Modularization	20
Insufficient Modularization	56
Deficient Encapsulation	57
Unnecessary Abstraction	40
Unutilized Abstraction	190
Broken Modularization	2
Broken Hierarchy	51

Key Observations and Correlation with SonarQube Findings

1. Confirmation of God Package / Centralized Complexity

Designite reported:

- **4 God Components**
- **24 Feature Concentration instances**
- **56 Insufficient Modularization cases**
- **70 Scattered Functionality instances**

These results strongly validate the SonarQube observation that the system suffers from excessive centralization of logic, particularly in the UI layer. The presence of multiple God Components confirms that a small number of modules are overloaded with responsibilities, directly supporting the conclusion of a **God Package / God Class** design smell.

2. Evidence of Layer Violations and Boundary Erosion

Designite detected:

- **25 Cyclic Dependencies**
- **20 Cyclically-dependent Modularizations**
- **17 Unstable Dependencies**

These findings empirically confirm that architectural layering is violated. Cyclic dependencies between packages indicate that higher-level components depend on lower-level ones and vice versa, contradicting clean architectural principles. This aligns directly with SonarQube metrics showing disproportionate complexity in the UI layer and confirms the presence of **Layer Violation and Boundary Erosion** as a major design smell.

3. Validation of Feature Envy

Designite explicitly detected:

- **7 Feature Envy instances**
- **1065 Law of Demeter violations**
- **81 Excessive Dependency instances**

These results confirm that multiple methods operate primarily on data belonging to other classes, rather than their own. This validates the earlier observation from SonarQube and UML analysis that UI action classes contain misplaced business logic and directly manipulate domain objects, confirming the presence of the **Feature Envy** design smell.

Conclusion

The Designite Java analysis strongly corroborates the findings derived from SonarQube metrics and UML examination. The key conclusions are:

- The system exhibits **God Package/God Component characteristics**, with logic concentrated in a few oversized modules.
- There are widespread **Layer Violations and Cyclic Dependencies**, confirming erosion of architectural boundaries.
- The presence of **Feature Envy** demonstrates that responsibilities are frequently misplaced across classes.
- High coupling and modularization issues indicate poor separation of concerns and low maintainability.

Overall, the Designite results provide independent validation that the Apache Roller codebase suffers from significant architectural design smells, fully supporting the conclusions drawn from the SonarQube-based analysis.